

1.d) Problems of objectivity in Anthropological research

Objectivity refers to the collection of quantifiable data as part of research work.

Problems with objectivity in Anthropological research

- ① As anthropologists study everyday lives of culture, it is hard to quantify lived experiences.
- ② Issues in quantifiable interpretation of social variables
- ③ Many anthropological experiences are symbolic and have varying interpretations.
- ④ Heterogeneity of culture
- ⑤ Objectivity pushes for ethnocentric view as done earlier by E.B. Tylor, Morgan etc.

At same, ~~time~~, objectivity is also useful
in anthropology →

① For biological anthropology for collecting
morphometric data. (eg. nutrition
anthropology).

② As part of Action Anthropology to
collect ~~whether~~ and monitor government
policies.

③ To support the results from qualitative
students (eg. Xaxa studied witchcraft
in Central India and interpreted
underdevelopment as reason ⇒ support
with quantifiable government data.

Today anthropology tries to project
an Emic view while also
showcasing objectivity by supporting
the qualitative arguments as done by
Christin Abiden in her work Studying
Fame Online.